

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 332

By Fritts

A RESOLUTION to honor Chief Warrant Officer 3 Phyllis Ann Fitzgerald, United States Army, (ret.) for her lifetime of service.

WHEREAS, citizens of the Volunteer State have a long history of sacrifice to our nation in times of conflict and service during times of peace; and

WHEREAS, this is not limited to the men from Tennessee but includes extraordinary women who answer the call to military service; and

WHEREAS, often this call to serve begins at an early age, resulting in a retirement from the military and a continued civilian service to fellow citizens; and

WHEREAS, one such distinguished individual is Chief Warrant Officer 3 Phyllis Ann Fitzgerald, who proudly served for twenty-one years in the United States Army and carried her lifetime of service into civilian life, holding the esteemed role of executive director for the Society of the First Infantry Division; and

WHEREAS, Chief Warrant Officer 3 Fitzgerald stands as a fine example of Volunteer Women Veterans; her military resume demonstrates loyalty, duty, respect, selfless service, honor, integrity, and personal courage; and

WHEREAS, born and raised in Tennessee, Phyllis Fitzgerald volunteered to serve in the U.S. Army and entered the military at the age of seventeen with her parents' signatures; she was in the last class of the Women's Army Corps, completing her basic training at Fort McClellan, Alabama in 1978; and

WHEREAS, after basic training, she attended advanced individual training at Fort Huachuca, Arizona, where she was trained as an intelligence analyst; in 1989, she applied for

and was accepted to the Army Warrant Officer Corps, graduating as an All-Source Intelligence Analyst; and

WHEREAS, her first assignment as a Warrant Officer was with the 1st Infantry Division, where she served from 1989 to 1993; she was assigned as an All-Source Intelligence Technician to the Assistant Chief of Staff, G2 at Fort Riley, Kansas; and

WHEREAS, she deployed to the Middle East for Operations Desert Shield/Desert Storm with the 1st Infantry Division, where during deployment, she briefed daily the commander of the 1st Infantry Division, General Thomas Rhame, on the enemy current situation, capabilities, and assessments; and

WHEREAS, during her military career, she served at various echelons, including Battalion, Division, Corps, and Echelons above Corps; she holds an associate degree from City Colleges of Chicago, a Bachelor of Social Science degree from Upper Iowa University, and a Master of Science Administration degree from Central Michigan University; and

WHEREAS, after leaving the military, CW3 Fitzgerald offered herself for public office and served as the mayor, vice mayor, and city commissioner of Junction City, Kansas, during which time she also served on a number of civic and nonprofit organizations, including the Military Affairs Council, Junction City Chamber of Commerce, AUSA, Armed Forces Community Foundation, and Central Kansas Military Community Foundation; and

WHEREAS, committed to helping her fellow veterans, she was appointed by Kansas Governor Laura Kelly to the Veteran's Claims Advisory Panel Board; she also led community volunteer projects and engaged soldiers and community members to volunteer; she also developed and ran The Adopt A Soldier program for new-to-the-Army and Fort Riley soldiers; and

WHEREAS, she led a project in her community to honor the 1st Infantry Division's 100th anniversary in 2017 and compiled a book, *What is Your Big Red One Story?*, of 100 Big Red One Stories of veterans that remained in Junction City, Kansas, after departing the military; and

WHEREAS, for five years, she served as the executive director of the Society of the First Infantry Division, a nonprofit organization that has over 9,000 members that were former and active-duty 1st Infantry Division soldiers, and continues to share her time and talents as a consultant with this exemplary organization; and

WHEREAS, no stranger to honors and accolades, she has received the Bronze Star Medal and the Meritorious Public Service Medal from the Department of the Army; the Seitz Family Military Community Award of the Year from the Junction City Area Chamber of Commerce; the Jefferson Award from KSNT News; Distinguished Trooper of the Year; Citizen of the Year from Omega Psi Phi Fraternity, Inc., Phi-Xi Chapter; and the Lockheed Martin Employee Spotlight Award, to name but a very few; and

WHEREAS, she is a member of the Old Trooper Regiment, Lady Trooper, and American Legion Post 254 in Collinwood; and

WHEREAS, returning to her native Tennessee in August 2024, Phyllis Fitzgerald resides with her husband of forty-one years in Collinwood; they are the proud parents of two children, daughter Amanda and their late son Jarid, and loving grandparents of five grandchildren; and

WHEREAS, the month of March was officially designated as Women's History Month in 1987, with President Ronald Reagan issuing the first presidential proclamation to commemorate the celebration; and

WHEREAS, every March, Women's History Month provides an opportunity to honor the achievements of those women who have paved the way wherein every person has an opportunity to pursue the American dream; and

WHEREAS, CW3 Fitzgerald is an example of both the Volunteer Spirit and one dedicated to a life of service, and in saluting her during Women's History Month, let us remember that when women succeed, America succeeds, as does Tennessee; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we hereby honor Chief Warrant Officer 3 Phyllis Ann Fitzgerald, U.S. Army (ret.) on her lifetime of service as we celebrate Women's History Month and the generations of trailblazing women who have built our State and their vital contributions to our country's history.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.